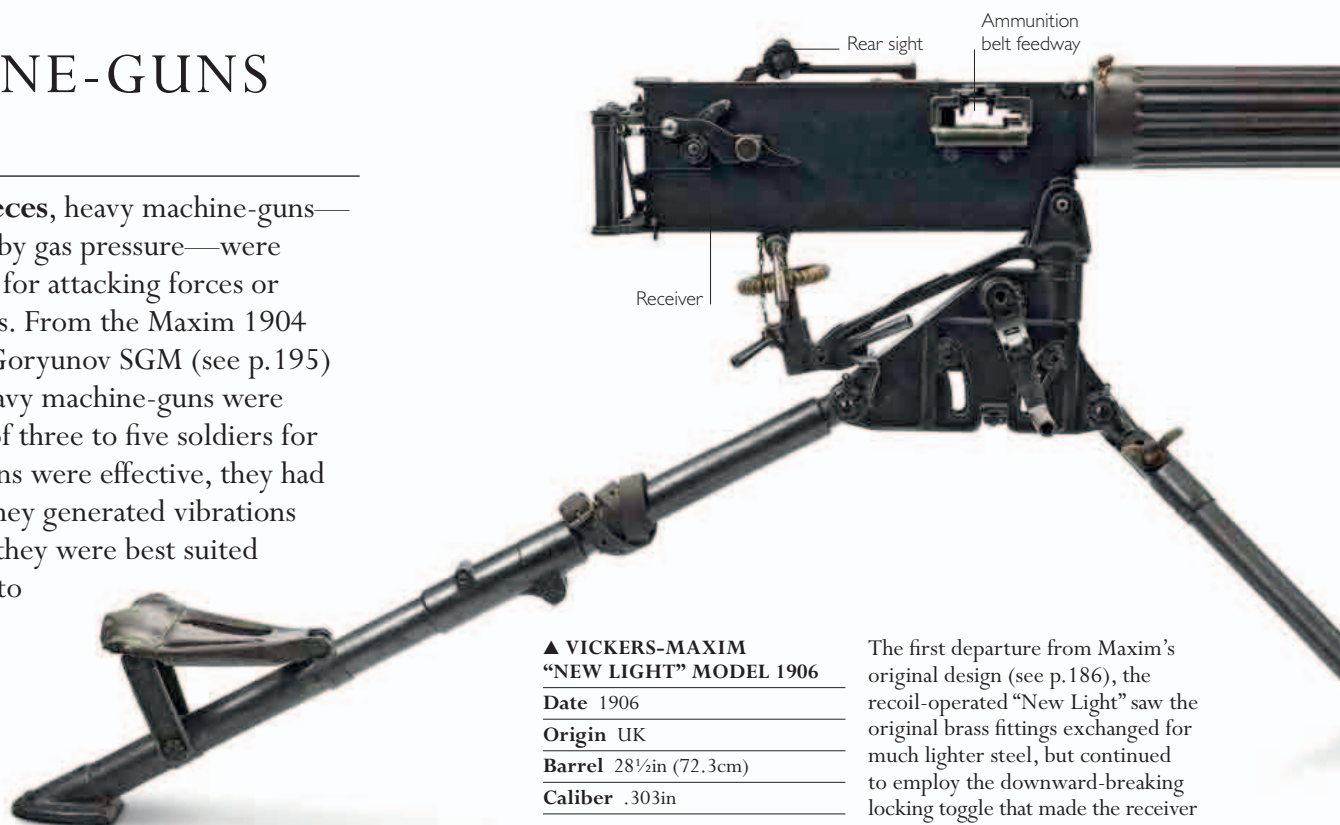


HEAVY MACHINE-GUNS (1900–10)

Viewed almost as artillery pieces, heavy machine-guns—some operating by recoil, others by gas pressure—were designed to provide covering fire for attacking forces or defensive fire from fixed positions. From the Maxim 1904 machine-gun (see p.188) to the Goryunov SGM (see p.195) and the Russian Maxim 1910, heavy machine-guns were cumbersome and needed crews of three to five soldiers for operation. Although these weapons were effective, they had limited mobility. During firing, they generated vibrations that made them unstable, and so they were best suited for use from static mounts fitted to vehicles or, later, aircraft.



▲ VICKERS-MAXIM
“NEW LIGHT” MODEL 1906

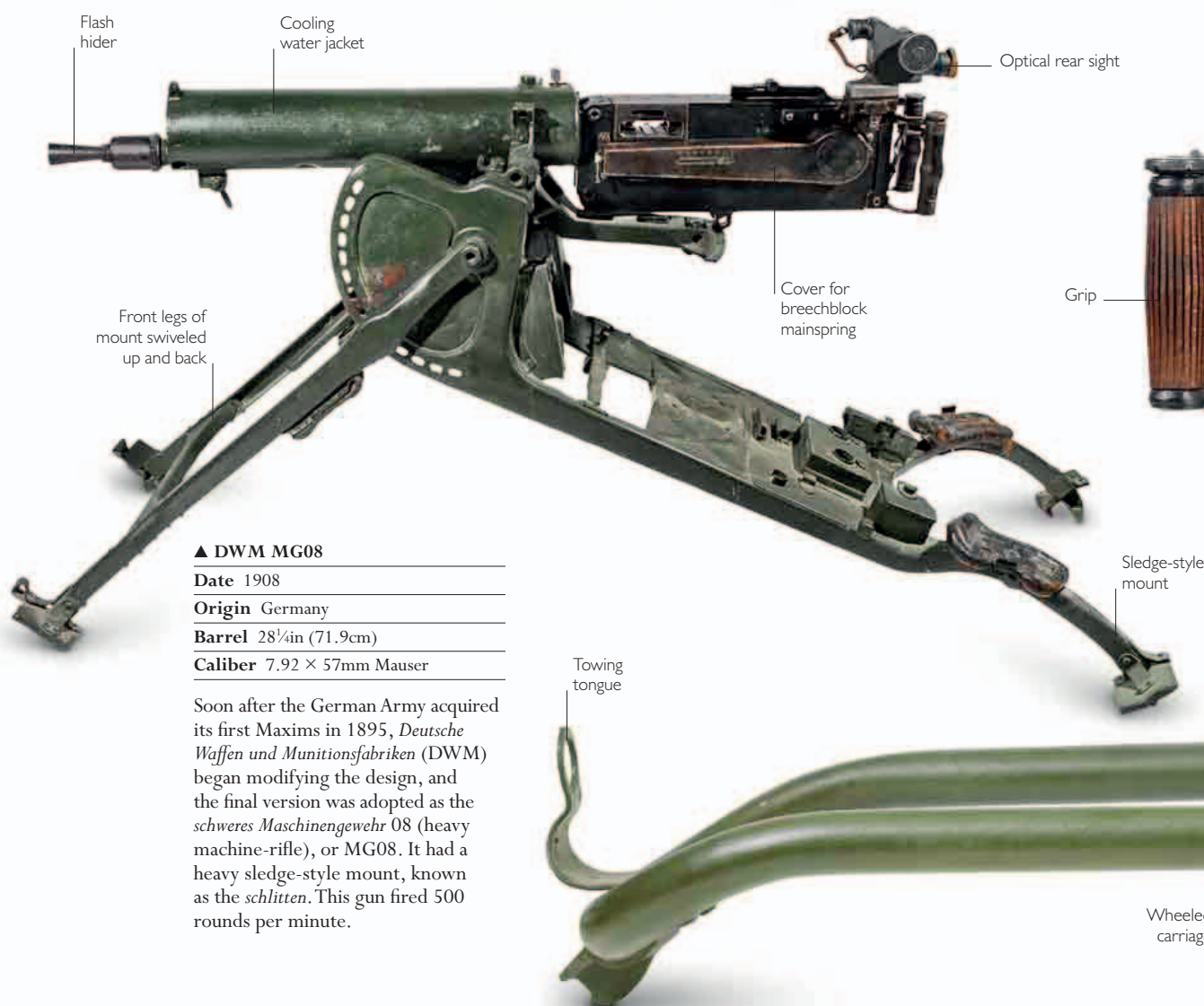
Date 1906

Origin UK

Barrel 28½in (72.3cm)

Caliber .303in

The first departure from Maxim's original design (see p.186), the recoil-operated “New Light” saw the original brass fittings exchanged for much lighter steel, but continued to employ the downward-breaking locking toggle that made the receiver large. Its rate of fire was 450–500 rounds per minute. The Russians adopted it as the M1910 (below).



▲ DWM MG08

Date 1908

Origin Germany

Barrel 28½in (71.9cm)

Caliber 7.92 × 57mm Mauser

Soon after the German Army acquired its first Maxims in 1895, *Deutsche Waffen und Munitionsfabriken* (DWM) began modifying the design, and the final version was adopted as the *schweres Maschinengewehr 08* (heavy machine-rifle), or MG08. It had a heavy sledge-style mount, known as the *schlitten*. This gun fired 500 rounds per minute.